

0.0.1 The Shorter Discourse on Analysis of Kamma

1. Thus, was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Savatthi in Jeta's Grove, Anathapindikā's Park. Then the brahmin youth Subha, Todeyya's son, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, he exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchange friendly greetings and cordial talk, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the brahmin youth Subha, Todeyya's son, said this to the Auspicious One:

2. What, O Master Gotama, is the cause, what is the reason why for human beings, for those who have come into being as humans, inferiority and superiority are clearly seen. For indeed, Master Gotama, human beings are seen to be short lived, long lived, of much sickness, of little sickness, ugly, beautiful, of little influence, of great influence, of little wealth, of great wealth, of lowly regarded families, of highly regarded families, unwise, wise. What, O Master Gotama, is the cause, what is the reason why for human beings, for those who have come into being as humans, inferiority and superiority are clearly seen.

3. "Beings, O Young Brahmin, are owners of their kamma, heirs of their kamma, born of their kamma, descendants of their kamma, have kamma as their refuge. It is kamma that distinguishes beings as inferior and superior."

4. I do not understand the detailed meaning of this statement that Master Gotama has given in brief without expounding the meaning in detail. May Master Gotama teach me the Dhamma in such a way that I can understand the detailed meaning of this statement that Master Gotama has given in brief without expounding the detail.

5. “Well then, Young Brahmin, listen and do mind it well. I will speak.”

6. Yes, the brahmin youth Subha, Todeyya’s son, assented to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this:

7. Here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man is a killer of living beings. He or she is cruel, bloody-handed, violent, merciless towards all living beings. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is short lived. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to short life. That is, being a killer of living beings, being cruel, bloody-handed, violent, merciless towards all living beings.

8. Yet here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, having abandoned the killing of living beings, abstains from the killing of living beings. Having buried the rod, having buried the sword, he or she dwells conscientious, with kindness and sympathy, compassionate for the welfare of all living beings. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in a happy destination, a heavenly world. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in a happy destination, a heavenly world, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is long lived. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to long life. That is, being an abstainer from the killing of living beings. Having buried the rod, having buried the sword, being one who dwells conscientious, with kindness and sympathy, compassionate for the welfare of all living beings.

9. Here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, is of a nature to injure beings with either fists, stones, sticks or knives. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is sickly. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading

the path that leads to sickness. That is, being one of a nature to injure beings with either fists, stones, sticks or knives.

10. Yet here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, is not of a nature to injure beings with either fists, stones, sticks or knives. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in a happy destination, a heavenly world. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in a happy destination, a heavenly world, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is seldom sick. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to good health. That is, not being of a nature to injure beings with either fists, stones, sticks or knives.

11. Here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, is prone to anger and easily annoyed. When being provoked even a little, he or she loses temper, becomes angry, upset, outraged, stubborn and displays anger, hate and bitterness. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is ugly. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path

that leads to ugliness. That is, being prone to anger and easily annoyed. Being one who loses temper when being provoked even a little, becoming angry, upset, outraged, stubborn, and displaying anger, hate and bitterness.

12. Yet here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, is not prone to anger and easily annoyed. When being provoked even a lot, he or she does not lose temper, becomes angry, upset, outraged, stubborn and display anger, hate and bitterness. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in a happy destination, a heavenly world. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in a happy destination, a heavenly world, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is elegant. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to elegance. That is, not being prone to anger and easily annoyed. Being one who when being provoked even a lot, does not lose temper, become angry, upset, outraged, stubborn and display anger, hate and bitterness.

13. Here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, has a mind of jealousy. Being obsessed with envy and resentment, he or she envies other's gain, honour, esteem, respect, homage and worship. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell. If with the breakup of

the body, after death, he or she does not arise in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is uninfluential. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to little influence. That is, having a mind of jealousy. Being one who is obsessed with envy and resentment and envious of other's gain, honour, esteem, respect, homage and worship.

14. Yet here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, does not have a mind of jealousy. Not being obsessed with envy and resentment, he or she does not envy other's gain, honour, esteem, respect, homage and worship. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in a happy destination, a heavenly world. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in a happy destination, a heavenly world, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is influential. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to great influence. That is, not having a mind of jealousy. Being one who is not obsessed with envy and resentment and envious of other's gain, honour, esteem, respect, homage and worship.

15. Here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, is not a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas. Having performed and under-

taken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, there is little wealth. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to little wealth. That is, not giving food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas.

16. Yet Here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, is a giver of food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in a happy destination, a heavenly world. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in a happy destination, a heavenly world, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, there is much wealth. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to much wealth, that is, giving food, drinks, cloths, vehicles, garlands, perfumes, ointments, beds, lodgings and lightings to samanas and brahmanas.

17. Here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, is arrogant and conceited, and does not pay respects to

those worthy of respect; does not stand up in the presence of those worthy to be stood up for; does not offer seats to those worthy of seats; does not yield way to those worthy of yielding way to; does not honor those worthy of honor; does not esteem those worthy of esteem; does not pay homage to those worthy of paying homage to; does not worship those worthy of worship. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is born in a lowly regarded family. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to birth in lowly regarded families. That is, being one who does not pay respects to those worthy of respect; does not stand up in the presence of those worthy to be stood up for; does not offer seats to those worthy of seats; does not yield way to those worthy of yielding way to; does not honor those worthy of honor; does not esteem those worthy of esteem; does not pay homage to those worthy of paying homage to; does not worship those worthy of worship.

18. Yet here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, is not arrogant and conceited, but pays respects to those worthy of respect; stands up in the presence of those worthy to be stood up for; offers seats to those worthy

of seats; yields way to those worthy of yielding way to; honors those worthy of honor; esteems those worthy of esteem; pays homage to those worthy of paying homage to; worships those worthy of worship. Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in a happy destination, a heavenly world. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in a happy destination, a heavenly world, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is born in a highly regarded family. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to birth in highly regarded families. That is, being one who is not arrogant and conceited, but pays respects to those worthy of respect; stands up in the presence of those worthy to be stood up for; offers seats to those worthy of seats; yields way to those worthy of yielding way to; honors those worthy of honor; esteems those worthy of esteem; pays homage to those worthy of paying homage to; worships those worthy of worship.

19. Here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, having approached a samana or brahmana, does not ask them questions: “What, O Bhante, is wholesome? What is unwholesome? What is blameworthy? What is blameless? What should be associated with? What should not be associated with? What is it that when undertaken, leads to one’s harm and suffering for a long time? What is it that when undertaken, leads to one’s welfare and happiness for a long time?” Having performed and under-

taken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she does not arise in the lower worlds, unhappy destination, the woeful plane, hell, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is unwise. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to lack of wisdom. That is, being one who, having approached a samana or brahmana, does not ask them questions: “What, O Bhante, is wholesome? What is unwholesome? What is blameworthy? What is blameless? What should be associated with? What should not be associated with? What is it that when undertaken, leads to one’s harm and suffering for a long time? What is it that when undertaken, leads to one’s welfare and happiness for a long time?”

20. Yet here, O Young Brahmin, a certain woman or man, having approached a samana or brahmana, asks them questions: “What, O Bhante, is wholesome? What is unwholesome? What is blameworthy? What is blameless? What should be associated with? What should not be associated with? What is it that when undertaken, leads to one’s harm and suffering for a long time? What is it that when undertaken, leads to one’s welfare and happiness for a long time?” Having performed and undertaken such kamma, with the breakup of the body, after death, he or she arises in a happy destination, a heavenly world. If with the breakup of the body, after death, he

or she does not arise in a happy destination, a heavenly world, but comes to the human state, then wherever he or she is born, he or she is wise. This, O Young Brahmin, is treading the path that leads to wisdom. That is, being one who, having approached a samana or brahmana, asks them questions: “What, O Bhante, is wholesome? What is unwholesome? What is blameworthy? What is blameless? What should be associated with? What should not be associated with? What is it that when undertaken, leads to one’s harm and suffering for a long time? What is it that when undertaken, leads to one’s welfare and happiness for a long time?”

21. Thus, O Young Brahmin, treading the path that leads to short life makes one short lived; treading the path that leads to longevity makes one long lived; treading the path that leads to poor health makes one sickly; treading the path that leads to good health makes one healthy; treading the path that leads to ugliness makes one ugly; treading the path that leads to elegance makes one elegant; treading the path that leads to little influence makes one uninfluential; treading the path that leads to great influence makes one influential; treading the path that leads to little wealth makes one be born to a poor family; treading the path that leads to great wealth makes one be born to a wealthy family; treading the path that leads to lowly-regarded family makes one be born in a lowly-regarded family; treading the path that leads to highly-regarded family makes one be born in a highly-

regarded family; treading the path that leads to little wisdom makes one unwise; treading the path that leads to great wisdom makes one wise.

22. “Beings, O Young Brahmin, are owners of their kamma, hiers of their kamma, born of their kamma, descendants of their kamma, have kamma as their refuge. It is kamma that distinguishes beings as inferior and superior.”

23. When thus was said, the brahmin youth, Subha, Todeyya’s son, said this to the Auspicious One: “Excellent, O Master Gotama! Excellent, O Master Gotama! Just as, O Master Gotama, one might set upright what has been overturned, or open up what has been closed, or show a path to one who is lost, or bear an oil lamp in the darkness so that those with good eyesight can see forms, just so has the Dhamma been explained by the venerable Gotama in countless ways. I go, to the Auspicious Gotama, as refuge, and to the Dhamma, and to the Sangha of bhikkhus. May Master Gotama bear it in mind, that I am a lay disciple who has gone for refuge from today for as long as life lasts.”